

Informed Consent Form

* Indicates required question

Informed Consent Form

Flag maker Activity Tests and Survey for CS1 and CS2 PDC Research

Hawaii Pacific University

Flag maker Activity Tests and Survey for CS1 and CS2 PDC Research

Hawaii Pacific University

Principal Investigator: Dr. Mary Smith

Department: Computer Science

Study Title: Flag maker activity to introduce parallel and distributed computing to CS1 and CS2 students

You are invited to participate in an online research study using a Flag maker activity to introduce parallel and distributed computing (PDC) to CS1 (CSCI 2911) and CS2 (CSCI 2912) students.

Please read this form and ask any questions you may have before agreeing to be a part of the study.

Location of the research:

The data collection by the PI will be done in one of the classrooms at HPU using class computers or student laptops. The time commitment required from the student will account for one class session and is designed to integrate with the course's learning objective and does not deter students from the scheduled coursework. No minors will be involved in the study. The survey results will be analyzed using popular statistical techniques such as z-tests, t-tests, sentiment analysis tools, etc.

Benefits of the research to society and/or the individual:

The anticipated benefits to the participant and future students enrolled in CSCI 2911 and CSCI 2912 and eventually CS1 and CS2 students across the nation include increased knowledge in a more modern computational model, including parallelism and distribution.

How may I withdraw from the study before, during, or after taking the survey?

Before taking the survey, the students can volunteer or withdraw from the survey using this informed consent. If you would like to withdraw from the study during or after taking the survey, contact Dr. Mary Smith (mlsmith@hpu.edu). Withdrawing from the study will not impact the course outcome or performance.

What will happen if I participate?

Your participation will take one class session in your current course. You will be asked to complete an online survey about your PDC experience that you gained after participating in the class activity called the Flag maker. It is ok to answer, "No experience at all". The class session will be divided into the following: once you complete this consent form and consent "YES" to participate, you will be taken to a page with (i) a pre-test that includes five fundamental questions on PDC topics. Before participating in the class activity, the test will be used to understand how much you already know about PDC fundamentals. It is ok to answer to the best of your knowledge. Any wrong answer will not impact your class grade. The PI will only use all answers to understand the knowledge level of participating students before the activity. The results will only be used for research purposes and will not in any way impact the final grade for the student in this class. The pre-test will be followed by (ii) the Flag maker activity and (ii) a post-test. The post-test will have the same five questions that are on the pre-test. The students can now answer the questions based on what they have learned about PDC from the Flag maker activity. Further, the last part of the class session will have (iv) a survey to collect information from the students on their experience with learning the PDC concepts during the Flag maker activity.

What are my options?

Your role as a participant in this study will include allowing de-identified data from the tests/surveys to be used in study results published to the computer science community. All information taken from the study will be coded to protect your name. No personally identifiable information will be included with your data, and your identity will be fully protected. Once the data has been fully analyzed, it will be destroyed. Your decision to participate is entirely voluntary, and you have the right to terminate your participation without penalty. If you do not wish to complete this survey, select "I do not consent" and close the form. The principal investigator of this study, Dr. Mary Smith, can be contacted via email at mlsmith@hpu.edu if you have any questions about this research study.

How will my information be used?

Efforts will be made to keep your personal information confidential. Absolute confidentiality cannot be guaranteed. All information taken from the study will be coded to protect your name. No personally identifiable information will be included with your data, and your identity will be fully protected. Once the data has been fully analyzed, it will be destroyed. Your identity will not be shared if the study findings are published or presented. Only Dr. Mary Smith will have access to the collected data. Any data disseminated to other institutions or the National Science Foundation will be entirely coded, anonymized, and de-identified.

What are my risks?

There are no risks to individuals participating in this survey beyond those in daily life.

Who can answer my questions about this study?

If you have questions about the study or encounter a problem with the research, contact the researcher, Dr. Mary Smith @ mlsmith@hpu.edu

1. Enter your HPU email address

2. Consent *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ I am 18 years of age or older, and I consent to participate in the study.
- ☐ I do not consent, I do not wish to participate, or I am under 18 years of age.

If you consented to participate in the study go to the pre-test form

Go to: [Pre/Post Survey](#)

